WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

NIGER

Africa

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Niamey	Capital and seat of government; centre for banking, public procurement, the BCEAO national agency and most investor-facing institutions	Financial services, telecoms, construction, public works
Agadem Basin (Diffa region, east)	Core oil-producing basin operated by CNPC subsidiaries, where the May 2026 settlement relaunches the Dinga Deep and Abolo-Yogou projects with $1 billion of investment	Upstream oil, oilfield services, local subcontracting
Niger–Benin export pipeline (WAPCO) to Sèmè-Podji	Crude export route to the Beninese coast; Niger now holds 45% of WAPCO and transport costs have fallen from $27 to $15 per barrel	Midstream logistics, pipeline security, maintenance services
Zinder (SORAZ refinery)	Home of the SORAZ refinery, which supplies refined products to the domestic and regional market	Refining, fuel distribution, petrochemical services
Agadez region (Arlit / In Azaoua uranium belt)	Historic uranium province; the former SOMAIR permit was awarded to the state entity Tsumco SA in August 2026 and the Madaouela I permit was re-awarded	Uranium mining, mining services, energy minerals
Tillabéri region (Kandadji dam and western gold belt)	Site of the Kandadji dam project and artisanal and semi-industrial gold activity near the Burkina Faso and Mali borders	Hydropower, irrigation, gold, agriculture
Maradi and the Nigeria border trade corridor	Commercial hub on the main trading route with Nigeria, Niger's large southern neighbour	Agri-trade, livestock, light manufacturing, logistics

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Investment Code (Law No. 2014-09) offering promotional and conventional privileged regimes, equal treatment of foreign and national investors, guarantees against uncompensated expropriation and ICSID arbitration after amicable settlement
- Single window for the Investment Code (Guichet Unique) under the industry ministry, with approvals due within 30 working days, alongside the Maison de l'Entreprise for company registration
- Petroleum sector entry through partnerships with the state and CNPC-led operators, under contracts the government has begun to publish as part of its IMF transparency commitments

- Mining Code requiring a minimum 10% free state stake, with the option for the state to acquire up to 33%; recent permits show the state favouring greater direct participation
- WAEMU membership and the CFA franc, pegged to the euro under the BCEAO, with the Investment Code guaranteeing transfer of profits and liquidation proceeds subject to exchange regulations
- OHADA uniform business law, with a national centre for business mediation and arbitration
- Free zone regime provided for in the Investment Code for export-oriented enterprises, set by decree

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Niger is one of Africa's fastest-growing economies in 2026, driven by its emergence as a crude oil exporter. Real GDP grew an estimated 6.9% in 2025 and the IMF and World Bank both project 7.0% for 2026, with prices falling (inflation of -4.7% in 2025 and -1.9% expected in 2026). On 29 July 2026 the IMF completed the ninth review of Niger's Extended Credit Facility, noting that all end-December 2025 performance criteria were met. Public debt is about 45.6% of GDP, and the IMF projects foreign direct investment rising from CFAF 108 billion in 2025 to CFAF 177 billion in 2026. The May 2026 agreement with CNPC and its partners is a turning point: $1 billion of new upstream investment, a 45% state stake in the WAPCO pipeline and a fall in transport costs from $27 to $15 per barrel, with output targeted to rise to 145,000 barrels a day by 2029.

Security and the state's assertive approach to natural resources are the defining structural challenges. Armed groups remain active in Tillabéri, Diffa and Dosso, more than 1 million people are displaced, and Niamey itself saw attacks on its airport in January and June 2026 and a coup attempt that was put down on 29 August 2026. In parallel, the government has nationalised SOMAIR, reassigned the former Orano uranium permit and cancelled several gold concessions, while Orano's arbitration claims continue. The trend is towards negotiated outcomes rather than stand-off: the China oil settlement resolved a year of tensions with a balanced package, pipeline security has prevented further attacks, and Benin and Niger agreed a roadmap towards reopening their border in June 2026. For investors, the opportunity lies in partnership models aligned with national priorities in oil services, local content, power and agriculture, structured with strong contractual protections and security planning.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Security and travel restrictions	Insurgent activity persists in several regions, Niamey saw attacks in 2026, and the US maintains a Level 4 advisory with essential staff only at its embassy	Concentrate on secured sites and Niamey, use professional security, insurance and duty-of-care planning; pipeline protection has prevented further attacks
Resource nationalism and contract disputes	SOMAIR was nationalised, the former Orano permit reassigned to Tsumco SA, and several gold and exploration licences cancelled or not renewed; Orano and GoviEx have pursued arbitration	Agree terms early with the state, include ICSID or international arbitration and political-risk cover; the CNPC settlement shows negotiated outcomes are achievable
US and EU compliance considerations	The US suspended entry of Niger nationals from 1 January 2026, removed Niger from AGOA in 2024 and restricts most assistance; the EU's targeted Niger sanctions framework runs to October 2027	There are no broad UN, US or EU economic sanctions; screen counterparties against EU listings with sanctions counsel and plan visa and mobility logistics in advance
Regional realignment and Benin border closure	Niger left ECOWAS in January 2025 to form the AES, and the prolonged closure of the Benin border has weighed on trade	WAEMU membership preserves the currency anchor; a Benin–Niger roadmap to reopen the border was agreed in June 2026
Banking-sector constraints	Non-performing loans stood at 23.0% in March 2026, well above the WAEMU average, limiting local credit	An IMF-backed banking diagnostic is under way; bring external or DFI-backed financing and use regional banks
Public finances and debt	The IMF rates Niger at elevated risk of debt distress, and arrears have affected suppliers	Arrears have fallen to 0.1% of GDP and are due to be cleared externally by end-2026; higher oil revenue is earmarked for deficit reduction
Governance and transparency	Investors face an evolving regulatory approach and a large state role in strategic	Publication of oil contracts, asset-declaration reform and a forthcoming IMF

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
	sectors	governance diagnostic support greater predictability

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Niger combines strong growth, falling prices and an IMF programme that remains on track with a security and political environment that investors must assess plainly. The country is led by General Abdourahamane Tiani's military government, which has ruled since July 2023 and put down a coup attempt in Niamey in August 2026. Niger is not subject to broad UN, US or EU economic sanctions, but there are practical compliance constraints: the EU maintains a targeted sanctions framework on Niger, renewed to 24 October 2027; the US has suspended entry of Niger nationals since January 2026, restricts most bilateral assistance and removed Niger from AGOA; and Niger has suspended visas for US citizens in response. The state's direct role in uranium, oil and gold means ownership terms and licence obligations should be agreed carefully and documented. With oil exports growing, a lower pipeline tariff, a stable CFA franc anchor and improving arrears management, investors who use sanctions and local legal counsel, security advisers and political-risk insurance can position for sectors where national priorities and private capital meet.

MARKET ACCESS

Niger is a member of the West African Economic and Monetary Union (WAEMU), sharing the euro-pegged CFA franc and a regional securities market with seven other states, and of the OHADA business-law area. It left ECOWAS in January 2025 and is a founding member of the Alliance of Sahel States with Burkina Faso and Mali, which has created a common passport, a confederal parliament and a Confederal Investment and Development Bank (BCID-AES); ECOWAS continues to apply its trade liberalisation scheme to AES members until further notice. Niger is a WTO member but lost AGOA preferences from January 2024. Crude oil, uranium and gold are the main exports, with crude moving by pipeline to the Beninese port of Sèmè-Podji and other trade passing through Nigeria and coastal corridors while the Benin road border remains closed.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Presidency (General Abdourahamane Tiani)	Leads the military-led transition and sets security, sovereignty and natural-resource policy	Primary reference point for strategic direction and approval of major projects
Investment Code Single Window and Maison de l'Entreprise	Process applications for Investment Code regimes and company registration	Standard first point of contact for incentives and market entry
BCEAO (Central Bank of West African States)	Regional central bank managing the CFA franc; held its policy rate at 3.00% in September 2026	Relevant for currency, transfers and banking-sector matters
Ministry of Economy and Finance	Leads the IMF programme, budget, arrears clearance and regional debt issuance	Key counterpart for fiscal incentives, payments and public-private partnerships
CNPC and WAPCO (oil production and export pipeline)	CNPC subsidiaries dominate production and transport; the state now holds 45% of WAPCO	Essential counterparts for oil services, local content and logistics opportunities
SOPAMIN and Tsumco SA (state mining)	SOPAMIN holds the state's mining interests; Tsumco SA was created after SOMAIR's nationalisation and holds the In Azaoua uranium permit	Key counterparts for uranium-sector partnerships, offtake and services
Confederal Investment and Development Bank (BCID-AES)	AES development bank launched in December 2025 to fund regional infrastructure	Relevant for regional infrastructure co-financing across Niger, Mali and Burkina Faso

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of Niger is the principal channel to domestic business, and the Maison de l'Entreprise supports company creation. The IMF, through its Extended Credit Facility, and the World Bank, which is supporting the banking sector and small businesses, remain active and are a useful source of macroeconomic and policy insight. CNPC and its partners, including WAPCO, are the main entry points for oil-sector subcontracting under the local-content commitments agreed in 2026. The WAEMU regional securities market and the BCID-AES are emerging channels for financing, and Niger's diplomatic missions and the AES institutions provide routes into government dialogue.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Niger best suits experienced frontier-market investors with a high tolerance for security and political risk and a partnership-based approach: oilfield services, logistics and local-content suppliers serving an oil sector targeting 145,000 barrels a day by 2029; energy-minerals and mining-services firms willing to work alongside state companies; power, solar and irrigation developers linked to projects such as the Kandadji dam; and agribusiness, telecoms and financial-services investors serving a young and fast-growing population. Investors should be comfortable with state participation, rigorous sanctions and counterparty screening, and with planning for evolving regional and security conditions.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Commission sanctions, legal and security due diligence
Retain sanctions and local counsel to screen counterparties against EU listings, review US entry and visa constraints, and secure security support and political-risk insurance before committing capital.

STEP 2: Apply through the Investment Code Single Window
Identify the applicable promotional, conventional or free-zone regime under Law No. 2014-09 and prepare an application for approval.

STEP 3: Engage oil-sector operators on local-content opportunities
Approach CNPC subsidiaries and WAPCO on subcontracting, services and logistics openings created by the 2026 settlement and the relaunch of Agadem projects.

STEP 4: Structure contracts for predictability
Use Investment Code agreements, OHADA-compliant structures and ICSID or international arbitration clauses, and document ownership and state-participation terms clearly.

STEP 5: Track border, regional and financing developments
Follow the Benin border roadmap, AES integration, IMF programme reviews, BCEAO policy and new co-financing sources such as the BCID-AES.